GAYAN SASANKA DISSANAYAKE

Full Stack Software Engineer | React | Node.js | TypeScript | SQL/NoSQL | AWS

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PROFILE

Full-stack software engineer with 2+ years of professional experience building web applications across the stack, from **React and Next.js front ends to Node.js and NestJS back ends, APIs, and cloud platforms including AWS and Firebase**. Strong hands-on experience delivering modern, maintainable software and adapting quickly to new technologies, teams, and business contexts.

Holds a **First-Class Honours Master of Information Technology from the University of Waikato** and a BEng (Hons) in Software Engineering from the University of Westminster. Currently volunteering as a **Front-End Engineer at GDC Consultants Ltd** in Hamilton, contributing to a UI modernisation project using **React, Redux Toolkit, and Redux Saga**.

Open to opportunities across **software engineering, full-stack development, and front-end development**. Brings experience working across **diverse environments, from international software teams to high-volume customer-facing work at Mitre 10 MEGA Hamilton**, with strong communication, problem-solving, and a practical approach to delivering value.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Front End	**React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Redux, Redux Toolkit, Redux Saga, React Hooks, React Router, Context API, Bootstrap, Tailwind CSS, Material UI, HTML5, CSS3**
Back End	**Node.js, NestJS, REST APIs, GraphQL, Axios, Prisma (ORM and schema design), C# (actively learning)**
Databases	**MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Firestore, AWS DynamoDB, schema design, data modelling**
Cloud & DevOps	**AWS (EC2, Cognito, Lambda, S3, SQS, DynamoDB), Firebase, Vercel, Git, GitHub, CI/CD**
Testing	**Jest (unit testing), TDD practices, Postman (API testing), CI/CD pipelines**
Methodologies	**Agile/Scrum, Clean Code, sprint planning, stakeholder communication, Git-based collaboration**
Tools	**Figma, Trello, Notion, Slack, Miro, Microsoft 365**

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Front End Engineer (Volunteer) | GDC Consultants Ltd, Hamilton | *2026 - Present*

- Contributing to a UI modernisation project within a small development team, building reusable React components and refactoring legacy code as the product transitions to a new interface.
- Working with React, Bootstrap, Redux Toolkit, and Redux Saga, applying component-driven development practices to deliver consistent and maintainable front-end architecture.

Software Development Intern | Auckland ICT Graduate School, University of Waikato | *2025*

- Delivered full-stack integration work on the Te Ra Māori digital archive, building secure Single Sign-On using server-side authentication logic, role-based access control, and Linux environment configuration.
- Served as a key communicator between the development team and project stakeholders, managing expectation-setting around project delays and scope changes, and facilitating multiple pivots while keeping delivery on track.
- Collaborated in an Agile team using Trello for sprint management, adapting to frequent project changes and demonstrating strong communication and problem-solving skills in a professional NZ setting.
- Systematically debugged complex environment and authentication issues, applying a structured troubleshooting mindset used in enterprise software platforms.

Software Developer | Digital Yogin SRL, Italy (Remote) | *2023*

- Designed and delivered multiple full-stack web applications end-to-end, architecting NestJS and Node.js back-ends, building REST APIs with Prisma ORM and schema design, integrating third-party services, and deploying to production in Agile sprints.
- Developed React front ends with custom hooks, Redux and Context API state management, React Router, and reusable component libraries, ensuring responsive and maintainable UIs tightly integrated with back-end APIs via Axios and GraphQL.

- Built scalable, high-performance database layers using Firestore (NoSQL), MongoDB, and MySQL, designing schemas, queries, and real-time data pipelines for production workloads.
- Collaborated across design, product, and engineering, managing sprint reviews, weekly releases, bug triage, and Git-based team workflows in a fully remote international team.

Software Developer Intern | Mediio Ltd, South Korea (Remote) | *2021*

- Built a responsive doctor-patient consultation platform (Medigrant) using Node.js, GraphQL, ReactJS, Material UI, and AWS S3, delivering a complete working product from design through deployment.
- Translated UI/UX wireframes into clean, accessible React components, ensuring cross-browser compatibility and mobile responsiveness.
- Delivered features under strict deadlines with peer code review, developing a collaborative, feedback-driven working style suited to fast-moving engineering teams.

KEY PROJECTS

eVoting System | University of Waikato - Group Project | *2025*

- Led the Web Application module for a secure, scalable NZ online voting system: front end in Next.js, ReactJS, and TypeScript; back end on AWS Lambda, DynamoDB, SQS, and Cognito.
- Took full ownership of the module end to end, delivering under a 10-week deadline using Agile tools and TDD-aligned engineering principles.

Pet Social Media Platform | University of Waikato - Master's Project | *2025*

- Architected and built a complete full-stack social platform: React/Next.js/TypeScript front end, NestJS REST API back end, MongoDB Atlas database, Socket.io real-time messaging, and JWT authentication.
- Delivered secure authentication, real-time features, and an intuitive UI, taking full ownership of the project end to end and completing delivery independently within 12 weeks.

Personal Portfolio | Personal Project - Live on Vercel | *2025*

- Built with Next.js, ReactJS, TypeScript, LeafletJS, and Three.js, featuring interactive maps and 3D visualisations, demonstrating modern front-end depth and initiative.

EDUCATION

Master of Information Technology (First-Class Honours) | University of Waikato, New Zealand | *2025*

BEng (Hons) in Software Engineering | University of Westminster, United Kingdom | *2021*

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Customer Service Representative | Mitre 10 MEGA Hamilton, NZ | *2024 – Present*

- Delivered front-line customer service and online order management in a high-volume retail environment, handling 100+ daily interactions and resolving complex customer queries across in-store, phone, and digital channels.
- Worked across multiple departments including OMNI, CSD, Pricing and Ticketing, Checkouts, and Night Fill, demonstrating adaptability, attention to detail, and the ability to perform consistently across varied roles under pressure.
- Resolved daily technical issues including POS glitches, scanner failures, and web order errors through systematic troubleshooting, a mindset directly transferable to diagnosing software and platform issues.

After School Facilitator (Volunteer) | Efalata Trust, Hamilton | *2024*

- Tutored students in English and Mathematics and led community initiatives, demonstrating mentorship, teamwork, and commitment to community outcomes.

ACHIEVEMENTS & LEADERSHIP

- **School Colors Award - Cricket:** Recognised for performance in the Battle of the Blues (Royal College vs S. Thomas' College, Sri Lanka) - Second longest running sporting rivalry in the world since 1879.
- **Senior Prefect, Royal College Colombo:** Elected to lead school-wide initiatives, mentor junior students, and represent the school in academic and community forums.